could break all types of encryption, including those used by banks, credit card companies, retailers, health-care providers, and governments.

In March 2014, First Look Media revealed an automated NSA system code named TURBINE that could hack into computers, gather data off hard drives, infect computers with malware, record audio from computer microphones, take photos with webcams, deny access to certain websites, and take data from flash drives.

A document released by the *Intercept* in May 2015 described how the NSA has been automatically converting phone calls into searchable text documents. In June 2015, an article published in the *New York Times* and *ProPublica* revealed that in 2012, the Obama administration asked the NSA to step up its hunt for evidence of malicious computer hacking. As a result, the Justice Department permitted the NSA to search Internet cables on US soil without warrants.

The reaction to the initial leaked documents was swift and loud. Although Snowden was pleased they were gaining so much attention, he was now a wanted man and fleeing from a government that wanted to prosecute him.

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